

The path to a new pope

Francis’ funeral will be followed by days of mourning and a conclave to choose his successor.

BY KAREN GARCIA

Pope Francis’ funeral will be held Saturday in St. Peter’s Square, marking the beginning of a highly choreographed process to select a new pope that is steeped in both history and politics.

All of the 252 cardinals from across the globe will attend the funeral — and at least 120 will then convene to elect the next leader of the Catholic Church’s 1 billion members in a sacred process known as the conclave. There is already much speculation about whom the cardinals will select and whether that new pope will continue Francis’ pastoral priorities of concern for the poor and reform of the Vatican bureaucracy.

On Monday morning, the Vatican announced the 88-year-old pope had died of a stroke and “irreversible cardiocirculatory collapse,” according to the Vatican News, an official publication of the Vatican.

As the church’s 266th leader, he was revered by many Catholics and theologians for his commitment to social justice and focus on church ministry to migrants, poor and oppressed people. Although he followed the church’s conservative doctrines on abortion and LGBTQ+ rights, he shook up the conservative norms of the church when he told clerics not to be “obsessed with” those issues.

The funeral is scheduled for 1 a.m. Pacific time.

Keeping with tradition, the Vatican’s health department verifies the pope’s death in his home, and his body is placed in a coffin and transferred to St. Peter’s Basilica for public viewing, the funeral Mass and burial.

During this time, Cardinal Kevin Farrell is acting as the cardinal camerlengo, a person appointed by the pope and tasked with certain duties during the transition to a successor, NPR reported. Those duties include destroying the late pope’s symbolic fisherman’s ring (used to seal Vatican documents) and preparing for the conclave.

The pope’s body must be

[See **Pope**, A6]



JOE RAEDLE Getty Images

PRESIDENT TRUMP greets Sylvester Stallone at the America First Policy Institute Gala in 2024. Days before taking office, Trump named Stallone, Jon Voight and Mel Gibson his “special ambassadors.”

Hollywood has yet to hear from Trump ‘ambassadors’

Just days before beginning his second term as president, Donald Trump called Hollywood “a great but very troubled place.”

Then, with his usual aplomb and bombast, he named Jon Voight, Sylvester Stallone and Mel Gibson to be his “special ambassadors.” The actors would be his “eyes and ears, and I will get done what they suggest,” he wrote on his social media platform.

Hollywood had “lost much business over the last four years to For-

Film industry doubts Jon Voight, Sylvester Stallone and Mel Gibson can keep production local

BY STACY PERMAN

eign Countries,” said Trump, and his trio of envoys will help bring it “back — bigger, better, and stronger than ever before!”

Three months later, many of those who work in Hollywood — industry players and officials who have been actively engaged in efforts to boost production — say as far as Trump’s envoys are concerned, it has been mostly “crickets.”

Although the administration has

[See **Hollywood**, A7]

Has YouTube become television itself?

20 years in, video pioneer is a power in industry it disrupted

BY WENDY LEE

The grainy 19-second YouTube video that started it all hardly had the makings of a viral sensation.

Shot at the San Diego Zoo, the primitive video clip showed Jawed Karim, the platform’s co-founder, complimenting the elephants in the frame behind him. “The cool thing about these guys is they have really, really, really long trunks,” Karim said.

The clip, titled “Me at the zoo,” was the first video uploaded to YouTube 20 years ago, opening the door to a new medium of television.

From those modest beginnings, the site opened the gates for users from around the world to post funny, viral videos that could take the internet by storm, racking up millions of views and earning some millions of dollars.

YouTube has evolved into not a mere tech operation, but a formidable force in television.

Popular music artists such as Justin Bieber rose to fame on YouTube and social media stars including Mr-Beast turned their large followings into powerful entertainment companies. The destination for homemade videos such as “Charlie bit

[See **YouTube**, A9]



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

DHAR MANN Studios’ Ruben Ortiz on a Burbank set. It has steadily built an audience on YouTube.

Rubio unveils department plan

The secretary of State wants to cut staff in U.S. by 15% and close or consolidate more than 100 bureaus. **NATION**, A4

Lakers look to even their series

Tuesday night’s Western Conference first-round game ended after this edition’s deadline. For full coverage, go to **latimes.com/sports**.

Weather

Fog, then some sun. L.A. Basin: 69/53. **B6**

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DAVID BUTOW For The Times

HISTORIC HOUSES STAND STRONG

Villa Aurora and the Mann house, now museums that survived the Palisades fire, were occupied by writers Leon Feuchtwagner and Thomas Mann, who fled Nazi Germany and warned that what happened there could happen anywhere, a message worth heeding, Gustavo Arellano writes. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

High court may allow parents to pull children from LGBTQ+ lessons

BY DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court justices sounded ready Tuesday to give parents a constitutional right to opt out of public school lessons for their children that offend their religious beliefs.

At issue are new “LGBTQ-inclusive” storybooks used for classroom reading for pre-kindergarten to fifth grade in Montgomery County, Md., a suburb of Washington where three justices reside.

In recent years, the court’s six conservatives have invoked the “free exer-

cise of religion” to protect Catholic schools from illegal job-bias claims from teachers and to give parents an equal right to use state grants to send their children to religious schools.

During an argument on Tuesday, they strongly suggested that they would extend religious liberty rights to parents with children in public schools.

“They are not asking to change what is taught in the classroom,” Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh told an attorney for the court.

“As a lifelong resident of the county, I’m mystified at how it came to this. They

[See **Court**, A5]



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